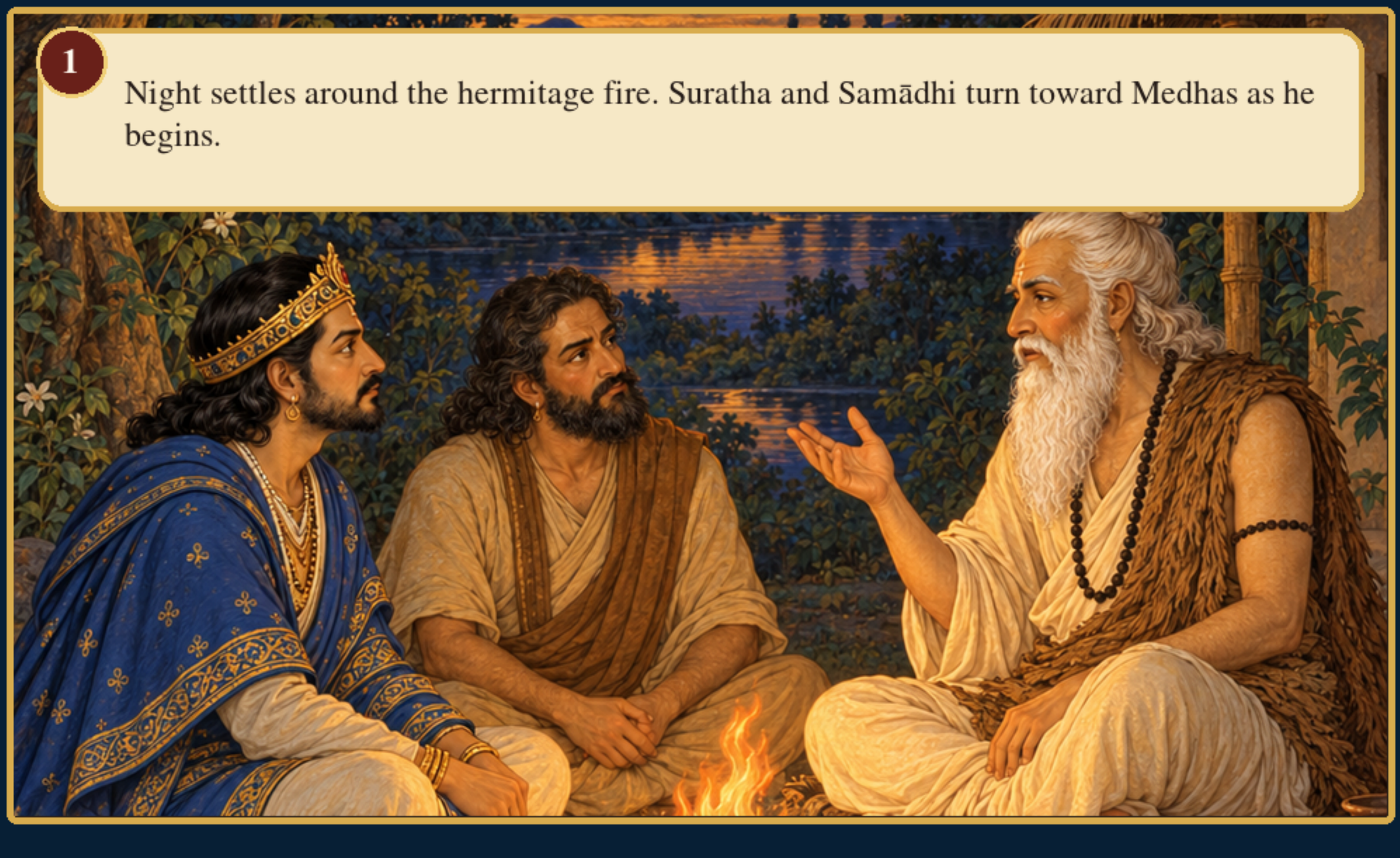
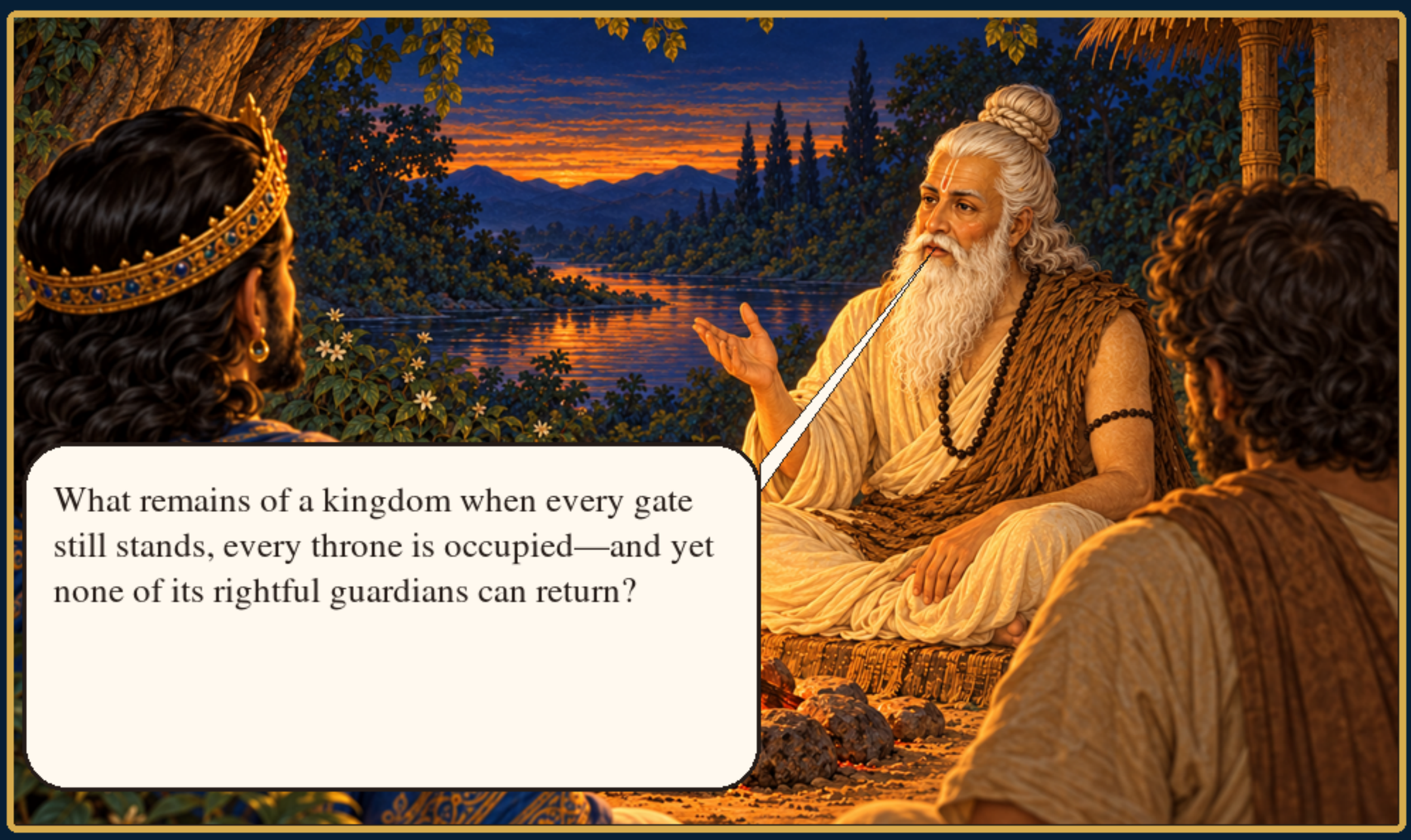
A QUESTION BENEATH THE TREES

1

Night settles around the hermitage fire. Suratha and Samādhi turn toward Medhas as he begins.





What remains of a kingdom when every gate still stands, every throne is occupied—and yet none of its rightful guardians can return?

INTERNAL PREVIEW — NOT APPROVED FOR PUBLICATION